Execution playbook | Do in order | 18 months

How to execute the Tier-1 SEO plan

Follow phases in sequence. Finish Phase 0 before scaling content. Companion to: Corp Crunch Tier 1 SEO Plan & Roadmap.

Phase 0	5	Weekly	3 roles
Start here (30 days)	Phases (0–4)	Cadence once live	Growth · Editorial · Eng

> **Rule of execution:** One owner per workstream. Ship weekly. Measure monthly against the scorecard. Do not skip index hygiene for more content volume.

Step 0 — Team setup (Day 1)

Role	Owns	Tools
Growth / SEO lead	GSC, rankings, scorecard, briefs	Search Console, GA4, Ahrefs/Semrush (optional)
Editorial lead	Cadence, hubs, PR→publish quality	Admin /admin/dashboard, style guide
Engineering	Sitemaps, CWV, schema, linking features	GitHub, Vercel, prod monitoring

Live: https://www.corpcrunch.io · Admin: /admin/login · Sitemaps: /sitemap.xml

Phase 0 — Stabilize (Days 1–30) START HERE

Goal: Trusted baselines and a clean index.

1. Verify Google Search Console for https://www.corpcrunch.io and https://www.corpcrunch.ai (DNS or HTML tag)
2. Submit sitemaps in both properties: /sitemap.xml — confirm URL count (~300+) and Status = Success
3. Export Coverage + Page indexing reports (CSV). Save baseline: indexed, discovered-not-indexed, excluded
4. Confirm GA4 receives organic traffic for both hosts; create weekly Organic Landing Pages exploration
5. Run PageSpeed / CWV on home + 1 article + /intelligent (mobile). Log LCP, INP, CLS
6. Spot-check 10 public URLs: robots index/follow, canonical, OG image, JSON-LD present (View Source)
7. Admin: open 1 PR draft → confirm SEO autofill → publish 1 polished article as dry-run of pipeline
8. Assign owners (SEO/Growth, Editorial, Eng) — share this playbook and Phase 0 deadline (30 days)

Phase 0 exit criteria: Both domains verified; sitemaps Success; baselines saved; mobile LCP issues listed with owners; one end-to-end PR draft → SEO → publish dry-run complete.

Phase 1 — Indexation & topical spine (Months 1–3)

Step 1 — News & crawl infrastructure Week 1–2

1. Eng: add Google News sitemap (articles < 48h) at /news-sitemap.xml and link from robots.txt
2. Growth: create Google Publisher Center / News publication for Corp Crunch; submit site
3. Eng: confirm Indexing API or ping path for new publishes (optional but preferred)

Done when: News sitemap returns 200; GSC shows it; test article appears as eligible.

Step 2 — Rebuild category hubs Week 2–4

1. Pick 6 priority hubs: technology, finance, sustainability, ai-innovation, fintech-growth, market-analysis
2. Editorial: write 150–300 word hub intro (what this desk covers + who it's for)
3. Eng: hub template = intro + top stories + related companies + FAQ schema block
4. Growth: target 1 primary keyword + 3 supporting per hub; track in sheet

Done when: all 6 hubs live with unique meta + internal links to ≥5 articles each.

Step 3 — Publish machine Week 3–6

1. Editorial calendar: ≥5 pieces/week (mix: news analysis, explainers, PR-sourced)
2. For every draft: use admin SEO autofill → human edit meta title/desc → featured image 1200×630 → Publish Public
3. Checklist before publish: slug clean, category set, alt text, OG image, allow index/follow ON
4. After publish: URL Inspection → Request indexing for pillar pieces only (not every post)

Done when: 70%+ of drafts that leave admin have complete SEO fields; weekly cadence held 4 weeks.

Step 4 — Internal linking pass Week 5–8

1. Eng: related-articles block from tags/category on article pages
2. Editorial: every new article links to hub + 2 related articles in body
3. Growth: orphan URL audit from GSC; fix or noindex thin pages

Done when: sample of 20 new URLs reachable ≤3 clicks from home.

Phase 2 — Authority (Months 4–9)

Step	What to do	How	Done when
2.1 Authors	Create author pages for active bylines	Person schema + bio + LinkedIn sameAs; link from articles	Each active author has a public URL

Step	What to do	How	Done when
2.2 Companies	Enrich /company pages for top covered firms	Description, logo, linked articles; ensure sitemap lists them	Top 50 companies have non-thin pages
2.3 Clusters	Build 8 topic clusters	1 pillar URL + ≥8 supporting articles each (AML, AI reg, ESG…)	Cluster map sheet complete + pillars live
2.4 Digital PR	Ship 1 original data brief / month	Charts from events/research; outreach to 20 journalists/partners	+ referring domains MoM
2.5 Trust pages	About, methodology, corrections, advertising	Linked in footer; Organization schema consistent	Brand SERP shows sitelinks candidates

Phase 3 — Aggregator product SEO (Months 10–15)

Step	What to do	How	Done when
3.1 Desks	Always-on AI / Finance / Sustainability desks	Dedicated hub + editor ownership + weekly package	3 desks each ranking for ≥1 head term
3.2 Feeds	Category RSS/JSON feeds	Eng exposes feeds; list in robots/footer for partners	Feed URLs live + documented
3.3 Product bridge	Articles → Intelligent / Finx / Solvterra	Contextual CTA modules by topic tag only	Organic→product CTR reported monthly
3.4 Events	AIX / C3 SEO packages	Entity pages, speaker schema, recap clusters pre/post event	Traffic spike attributed in GA4

Phase 4 — Tier-1 lane (Months 16–18)

Step	What to do	How	Done when
4.1 Speed to index	Sub-hour crawl for breaking desk	Indexing API on publish for news-tagged posts	Median index < 4h on sample
4.2 Knowledge	Brand entity consistency	Wikidata / logo / sameAs / NAP aligned with schema	Knowledge Panel or rich brand SERP
4.3 Multi-format	Video + magazine SEO	VideoObject + transcript pages; magazine indexable	Non-HTML formats in GSC queries
4.4 AI Overviews	Quotable unique data	Tables, definitions, clear entities on pillars	Citations / featured for priority topics

Weekly operating rhythm (after Phase 0)

Monday

- Editorial calendar lock
- GSC: new errors / coverage delta

Wed / Fri

- Publish + SEO checklist

Month-end

- Scorecard vs targets
- Kill/refresh losing URLs

- Assign hub owners for week

- Internal links on new posts
- Request index for pillars only

- Next month cluster priorities

Publish checklist (use every time)

#	Check	Where
1	Title ≥ 5 chars; slug lowercase hyphenated	Admin core
2	Meta title ≤ 60; meta description 120–160	SEO section
3	Featured image 1200×630; alt text filled	SEO section
4	OG title/desc/image filled (or autofill)	Advanced SEO
5	Allow indexing + follow links ON	Advanced SEO
6	Schema Article; language en; region set	Advanced SEO
7	Excerpt + reading time present	Content controls
8	Category + tags; 2 internal links in body	Core + body
9	Status Published + Visibility Public	Publishing
10	Live URL loads; GSC inspect if pillar	Production

> **Stop-the-line conditions:** Pause new publishing sprints if sitemap fails, there is a spike in soft-404s, accidental noindex on public articles, or Core Web Vitals regress badly on mobile home/article. Fix first, then resume cadence.